



During this time, the climate was warm and moist almost everywhere, with no polar ice. This encouraged the growth of dense forests of conifers, ginkgos, club mosses, cycads, and tree ferns that covered much of the land. Dinosaurs such as these two *Diplodocus*, which lived in what is now North America, had long, flexible necks for stretching high into

the trees to feed. They could even rear up on their hind legs for extra height. Similar to modern elephants, they also would have broken down a lot of trees, creating open areas where smaller plants such as ferns could flourish. *Diplodocus* fed on these, too, combing the stems through their peglike teeth to strip away the green foliage and gulping it down without chewing.